

REPORT ON WORKERS' DISCONTENT AT COMPANY'S AUXILIARY UNIT

Terms of Reference: In accordance with the instructions given to me on April 9, 2003, I visited the auxiliary unit of the Company in order to find out the causes and extent of discontent among the workers.

Procedure: In this connection, I interviewed supervisors, plant operators and twenty-five workers selected at random.

I found out the following facts that are responsible for this unrest.

Findings: There seems to be widespread discontent amongst workers. Several other personnel pointed out that the number of incidents of breach of discipline and general non-cooperative attitude had gone up considerably. They expressed the view that the situation was deteriorating and serious outbreaks of misbehaviour might result.

The workers, on their part, had some complaints also. According to them the supervisors were inadequate; the workers were given long hours on the production line; and skilled personnel were not eager to explain the working of the machinery to workers. There were other avoidable lapses that the workers resented. The skilled personnel, to save their own time, left the machines dirty so that workers have to clean them. Safety precautions in the machine room were continually being ignored. Further, there is widespread belief that the rates paid to workers are the lowest in the area.

Conclusion: I am of the opinion that immediate action must be taken to prevent further discontent and ill will. There is evidence to believe that all complaints are well founded. Deliberately ignoring safety precautions is an offence against the Factories Act and must be stopped.

Regarding pay and allowances it is necessary to bring to the notice of the workers that our rates compare favourably with those paid to apprentices in other similar units.

Recommendations: It is therefore my considered opinion that the following suggestions will go a long way in reducing the discontent:

- A special officer may be appointed and he should be asked to draw up a systematic programme for the unit.
- All supervisors must be strictly advised to keep machinery clean and observe all safety precautions.
- The Personnel Officer must point out to the workers that the rates of payment enjoyed in this factory are very favourable.

Sd/-

Trivikrama Rao

Company Secretary

April 24, 2003